

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, complex regulated software.*

Positioning, ten years owning product in regulated, workflow-heavy B2B environments – now bringing that depth to Personio's Payroll domain.

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Dear Personio team,

Payroll is the product domain where a missed edge case is not a UX annoyance – it is a failed tax filing or a late salary transfer. I have spent the past several years working in environments with exactly that level of consequence: a defence AI platform subject to multinational audit requirements, a public labour market analytics system operating under IT-security officer oversight, and an InsurTech SaaS where regulatory correctness was the core value proposition. In each case the challenge was the same as the one Personio's Payroll team faces: translate a complex, legally constrained workflow into software that is both correct and genuinely usable.

At Emil Group I took over a payroll-scale complexity: a multi-module InsurTech platform serving primary insurers, reinsurers, and brokers, with a 17-person team that had lost sprint discipline under delivery pressure. I split the team into smaller, accountable Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production. Client trust – which had eroded significantly – was rebuilt within weeks through weekly product workshops and transparent technical communication. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a data management platform inside the FCAS defence programme, writing specifications that spanned data transformation, audit trails, and ExplainableAI compliance across multinational stakeholders, then delivering features end-to-end including implementation support and GitOps rollout.

The Personio job description asks for someone who can develop deep customer understanding, decompose complex problems in close collaboration with Engineering and Design, and lead cross-domain topics. That is precisely the operating model I have built over nearly ten years. My approach starts with structured discovery – combining qualitative user sessions with quantitative usage and error data – and ends with a backlog that Engineering can actually execute against, with acceptance criteria that leave no compliance ambiguity on the table.

On the German language requirement: German is my native language, I studied and built companies in Berlin, and I have operated in German regulatory and government contexts

throughout my career. I understand the specific register that German payroll and authority communication demands.

I would be glad to walk through specific product decisions or trade-off reasoning in a conversation. Thank you for your consideration.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
